at the way relative strangers came up to me to share how highly they thought of my father. Unfortunately, I was unable to visit India on the day my father officially took over as the Chief, but I remained glued to the news the entire day.

This final job assignment gave me the opportunity to see my father in a new light—as a leader, an academic, a trusted adviser and a national icon in a high-stakes world. However, what I am most grateful for are the things that remained the same: hard work, humility and family.

Isha's musings . . .

2019 has ended and 2020 has begun. If I had to describe all the emotions I have been feeling these past few weeks, from disbelief to pride and happiness, it would need a whole book. Excitement and thankfulness on the day the baton was handed over and when we witnessed the Guard of Honour. We have been on a see-saw ever since General Rawat was selected as the COAS in December 2016. That brought Popsi (what we call my father) into the running for the next COAS, on General Rawat's superannuation, and we have been dealing with casual, throwaway comments for a couple of years. In my case, 16 December was almost an anticlimax. I had a long conversation with Mommy and Popsi around 7 p.m. about routine happenings, after which they went off to dinner with the CNS. I had planned to write report cards after dinner. After dinner, Simon and I happened to pick up our phones at about the same time and saw a WhatsApp message from our Principal, 'Congratulations . . . just saw the news' and my reply was, 'News?' Simon too had received a similar message. At this point, I started searching for news on Google but nothing was coming up. Then, more messages started trickling in and

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